Diego R. Caputo

PhD Student, Industrial & Systems Engineering · Lean, Continuous Improvement, AI in IE

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+ SUMMARY

PhD student in Industrial and Systems Engineering at Auburn University (expected 2027) with 10 years of experience across engineering, data analytics, and technical instruction. Skilled at breaking complex technical processes into clear, structured, verifiable content, and at reviewing work against defined quality criteria. Builds data tools and software in Python and R using AI-assisted development workflows. Experienced writing and teaching technical material for students and industry teams in English and Spanish.

+ CORE SKILLS

AI and data	AI-assisted software development, data quality review, data analysis, data modeling, ETL pipelines, dashboard development, technical writing
Programming and tools	Python, R, Excel, Power BI, Minitab, 3DVista
Engineering and process	Industrial engineering, Lean manufacturing, Six Sigma, DMAIC, root cause analysis, process mapping, value stream mapping, continuous improvement
Training and instruction	Curriculum and training module design, instructional content development, student assessment and project supervision, technical communication
Languages	English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)

+ EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant · Auburn University, Auburn, AL — Aug 2022 - Present

- Develop immersive 360-degree training modules and interactive learning activities for an NSF-funded project (DUE 2417082) on digital manufacturing education
- Conduct systematic literature reviews, synthesizing published research into structured findings for dissertation and journal manuscripts
- Map and assess process manufacturing operations, including sawmills, to identify improvement opportunities for the Auburn University Rural Partnership Institute
- Build websites, data analytics utilities, and educational software tools using AI-assisted development workflows

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Lean Systems (INSY 5800/6800) · Auburn University, Auburn, AL — Aug 2022 - Present

- Teach and facilitate Lean manufacturing content to 60 to 80 students per semester and about 20 students in summer project cohorts
- Deliver lectures and run structured simulation exercises covering 5S, Kanban, just-in-time, SMED, Heijunka, A3 problem solving, and Kaizen
- Evaluate student work and give feedback against defined technical criteria

Program Director, International Lean Six Sigma Green Belt Program · Auburn University, Germany — 2026

- Led program logistics, industry partnerships, course instruction, and supervision of student DMAIC improvement projects at German companies
- Coordinated international student cohorts in Germany and Pamplona, Spain (2025 and 2026), including projects with BSH Bosch

AI Trainer Specialist · Outlier, Remote — Dec 2024 - May 2025

- Trained and evaluated AI models by writing and reviewing prompts and responses against defined quality guidelines
- Applied engineering and technical domain knowledge to check the accuracy of model outputs and give structured feedback
- Met project quality standards and deadlines in a self-directed, remote role

Data Specialist · Bank Superintendence, Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic Mar 2021 - Jan 2022

- Designed executive dashboards to support decision making by senior leadership
- Built reusable ETL pipelines that cut data preparation time by about one week per reporting cycle

Systems Engineer II · Claro Dominicana, Distrito Nacional, Dominican Republic Oct 2017 - Feb 2021

- Analyzed and automated service provisioning processes for operating system services
- Assessed system requirements and feasibility to improve service activation efficiency

Production Supervisor · IE Industrial Electric S.A.S., Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic Jun 2016 - Dec 2017

- Supervised about 50 plant operators, meeting production, safety, and quality requirements
- Coordinated daily production schedules under constrained resources

+ EDUCATION

PhD, Industrial and Systems Engineering · Auburn University Expected 2027

MS, Industrial and Systems Engineering · Auburn University · GPA 3.94 Expected 2026

Master of Engineering Management, Systems Option · Auburn University · GPA 4.0 Dec 2023

BS, Industrial Engineering · Pontificia Universidad Católica Madre y Maestra · GPA 3.5 Sep 2017

+ CERTIFICATIONS

- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt, Auburn University
- Graduate Certificate, Modeling and Data Analytics for Operations, Auburn University
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt, Villanova University (starts 2027)

+ HONORS AND LEADERSHIP

- Winner, INCOSE Systems Showdown, 2026
- JT Black Lean Engineering Student of the Year, 2022
- IPC Scholarship, 2023, 2024, 2025
- President, SME Auburn University Student Chapter, 2025-2026
- Vice President, SHPE Auburn University Chapter, 2023-2024